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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BINDERS, LOOSE LEAF, (WITH OR WITHOUT FLEXIBLE PRONG)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers binders made of pressboard and equipped with or without metal prong fastener and compressor.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types, classes, and thicknesses.*—Binders covered by this specification shall be of the following types, classes, and thicknesses, as specified (see 3.1.1):

	Thickness
Type I.—Roll glazed.	0.020
	.025
Class I.—Without metal prong fastener and compressor.	
Class II.—With metal prong fastener and compressor.	
Type II.—Calendered.	.020
	.025
Class I.—Without metal prong fastener and compressor.	
Class II.—With metal prong fastener and compressor.	

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards.—The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

Federal Specifications:

FF-F-111—Fasteners, Paper-File, Metallic, Compressor.

UU-P-701—Pressboard; Colored.

CCC-T-191—Textile Test Methods.

PPP-B-585—Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.

PPP-B-591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.

PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.

PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

PPP-B-636—Boxes, Fiberboard.

PPP-B-676—Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Federal Standard No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, At-

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lanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL–B–4229—Boxes; Paperboard, Metal-Stayed.

MIL–B–10377 — Boxes; Wood-Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.

MIL–L–10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications.—The following publication forms a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Consolidated Classification Committee Publication:

Consolidated Freight Classification Rules

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Consolidated Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago 6, Ill.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 *Binder cover and binder stick.*—The binders shall be made of pressboard complying with the requirements of Federal Specification UU–P–701.

3.1.1.1 *Color.*—The color of the pressboard shall be red, black, gray, green, or blue, as specified.

3.1.2 *Metal prong fastener.*—The metal prong fastener with compressor shall conform to the requirements of Federal Specification FF–F–111 and shall be suitable for the hole spacings of 2¾, 4¼, 5½, 7, or 8½ inches, as specified. The length of the prongs shall be suitable for the capacities described in 3.5.

3.1.3 *Cloth hinge.*—The cloth hinge shall have a thread count of not less than 60 threads in the warp and not less than 50 threads in the filling. The cloth hinge shall have an Elmendorf tearing strength of not less than 70 (direct reading) when torn in the long direction of the binder.

3.1.3.1 *Color.*—The color of the cloth shall be brown for red pressboard and black for all other pressboard.

3.2 Construction. — The hinge assembly shall consist of cloth glued to a binding stick and shall have ¼ inch holes spaced 2¾, 4¼, 5½, 7, and 8½ inches apart, equidistant from the center of the hinge and approximate center (width) of the binding stick. The cloth shall overlap the binding stick and shall be glued to each side of the binder cover over a width of not less than ½ inch. The distance between the binder cover and stick shall be sufficient to permit flexing without interference. The hinge length shall be the same as the length of the binder. Two assemblies, as described, shall be furnished as a unit, joined by a metal prong fastener and compressor as described in 3.1.2.

3.3 Corners.—All corners of the nonbinding side shall be rounded.

3.4 Sizes.—The binder shall be suitable for the following sheet sizes, as specified (see 6.2.):

3.4.1 *Outer dimensions.*—The outer dimensions of binder shall be at least ½ inch larger than the sheet dimension.

3.5 Capacity.—The binders shall have a capacity of 1, 2, 3, 4, or 6 inches as specified (see 6.2).

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Binding side	Other side
Inches	*Inches*
5½	8½
6	9½
7	8½
7	11
8½	5½
8½	8½
8½	11
8½	14
10½	8
11	8½
11	14
11	17
12	9½
14	8½
14	17
17	14

3.6 Workmanship.—The binder shall be finished in a neat workmanlike manner. All edges and surfaces shall be smooth and free from defects and imperfections which may impair the serviceability of the binder.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Lot.—For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all the loose leaf binders of the same type and size offered for delivery at one time.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 *Sampling for inspection.*—A random sample of loose leaf binders shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105, Inspection Level I, Acceptable Quality Level of 2.5 percent defective.

4.2.2 *Sampling for test.*—A random sample of loose leaf binders shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level L2.

4.3 Inspection.—Each random sample taken in accordance with 4.2.1 shall be inspected for compliance with this specification with respect to size, color, construction, capacity, workmanship, packaging and packing, marking, and any other requirements of this specification which may be determined by visual examination.

4.4 Tests.—Each sample taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be tested as cited herein. Failure of any sample to pass any of the tests shall be considered cause for the rejection of the lot represented by the sample.

4.4.1 *Pressboard.* — Pressboard shall be tested in accordance with test requirements of Federal Specification UU–P–701.

4.4.2 *Metal fastener.*—Metal fastener shall be tested in accordance with test requirements of Federal Specification FF–F–111.

4.4.3 *Cloth.* — The cloth hinge shall be tested for tearing strength in accordance with test method No. 5132 of Federal Specification CCC–T–191.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

The definitions and applications of the Levels of Packaging and Packing shall be in accordance with Federal Standard No. 102.

5.1 Packaging.—Binders shall be packaged level A or C as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.*—Binders shall be packaged in full telescopic boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–676 or *Military* Specification MIL–B–4229. Unless otherwise specified, the quantity of binders per box shall be twenty-five.

5.1.2 *Level C.*—Binders shall be packaged in accordance with normal practice, twenty-five (25) to a box.

5.2 Packing.—Binders, packaged level A or C, shall be packed A, B, or C as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.*—Binders shall be packed in any one of the following overseas type shipping containers.

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Container	Specification No.
Wood-Cleated Fiberboard	PPP–B–591
Nailed Wood	PPP–B–621 (class 2)
Fiberboard	PPP–B–636 (class 2)
Wood-Cleated Veneer	MIL–B–10377
Wood Wirebound	PPP–B–585 (class 3)
Wood-Cleated Plywood	PPP–B–601

Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be provided with waterproof case liners conforming to class 2 of Military Specification MIL–L–10547 and sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto. Gross weight of wood and wood-cleated boxes shall not exceed 200 pounds; fiberboard boxes 70 pounds.

5.2.2 *Level B.*—Binders shall be packed in snug-fitting boxes conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification PPP–B–636, type I or II, class 1. Boxes shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.*—Binders shall be packed in containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carrier and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the Consolidated Freight Classification Rules or regulations of other carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civilian agencies.* — In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, each unit and intermediate package, and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

5.3.3 *Nomenclature.* — The nomenclature shall be as follows: "BINDERS, LOOSE LEAF, (WITH OR WITHOUT FLEXIBLE PRONG").

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.—Type I binder is intended for use where greater strength, high gloss, and durability are desired. Type II binder is intended for general purpose use.

6.2 Ordering data. — Procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type and thickness of pressboard (see 1.2 and 3.1.1).
(*c*) Color of binder (see 3.1.1.1).
(*d*) Spacing of metal fastener (see 3.1.2).
(*e*) Sheet size of binder (see 3.4).
(*f*) Capacity of binder (see 3.5).
(*g*) Both the level of packaging and the level of packing required (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

6.3 This specification includes the requirements of Military Specification MIL–C–17723 (S&A).

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility, nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army—Q
Navy—S MC
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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